

DARREN RICHARD KERN HEADLEY

Director of Information Technology and Digital Transformation

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

Strategic technology executive with more than 20 years of experience leading enterprise IT operations, cybersecurity governance, AI initiatives, infrastructure modernization, and institutional technology strategy.

Experienced in aligning enterprise technology operations with organizational goals through innovation, operational leadership, AI adoption, automation, and service delivery transformation.

Proven record delivering multi-campus modernization programs, disaster recovery initiatives, cybersecurity operations, AI-enabled services, and operational transformation within higher education and enterprise environments.

Recognized for executive leadership, stakeholder engagement, operational resilience, infrastructure governance, and technology strategy development.

CORE COMPETENCIES

- Artificial Intelligence Strategy and Adoption
- Digital Transformation Leadership
- Enterprise IT Operations
- Cybersecurity Governance
- Data Analytics and Reporting
- IT Governance and Compliance
- Infrastructure Architecture
- Disaster Recovery and Business Continuity
- Enterprise Systems Management
- Cloud and Hybrid Environments
- Strategic Technology Planning
- Vendor and Procurement Management
- Process Automation
- Enterprise Networking
- Operational Leadership
- Team Development and Mentorship
- Budget and Resource Management
- Stakeholder Engagement
- Service Delivery Management
- Institutional Technology Leadership

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Director of Information Technology and Digital Transformation

College of Science, Technology and Applied Arts of Trinidad and Tobago | January 2006 - Present

Provide executive leadership for enterprise technology operations across a multi-campus higher education institution supporting academic systems, cybersecurity operations, digital infrastructure, enterprise applications, cloud services, and institutional transformation initiatives.

- Lead institutional technology strategy aligned to operational and organizational objectives.
- Direct enterprise IT operations across multiple campuses, academic platforms, and institutional digital services.
- Oversee multidisciplinary teams across systems administration, networks, cybersecurity, infrastructure, enterprise applications, and help desk services.
- Drive digital transformation focused on modernization, process automation, AI adoption, and service optimization.
- Spearheaded AI-enabled services including chatbot technologies, automated communications, workflow automation, and AI-assisted administration.
- Directed infrastructure modernization across virtualization, cybersecurity systems, wireless networks, VoIP, cloud services, and disaster recovery environments.
- Managed enterprise cybersecurity operations including hardening, incident response coordination, access governance, and identity management improvements.
- Directed disaster recovery and business continuity programs including backup modernization, replication environments, and recovery planning.
- Managed strategic procurement, vendor negotiations, contract evaluations, and enterprise technology partnerships.
- Built executive reporting frameworks including KPI dashboards, analytics structures, and operational performance reporting.

Selected Earlier Roles

- Help Desk / Support Technician / Analyst, Software Technology Limited | January 2005 - January 2006
- Helpdesk Analyst, Scotiabank | January 2003 - January 2005
- Assistant System Administrator, Hadco Limited | January 2002 - January 2003

AI AND DIGITAL TRANSFORMATION LEADERSHIP

- Led institutional AI adoption initiatives supporting operational efficiency and service modernization.
- Directed implementation of AI-assisted communication and workflow automation systems.
- Designed AI-enabled operational strategies for higher education administration and student engagement.
- Led strategic discussions on AI governance, responsible AI usage, and institutional AI policy frameworks.
- Delivered AI awareness and adoption initiatives for staff, faculty, and institutional stakeholders.
- Managed AI-powered automation implementation using Microsoft 365 and enterprise workflow platforms.

TECHNOLOGY LEADERSHIP HIGHLIGHTS

- Directed modernization of enterprise learning management systems and digital learning environments.
- Managed enterprise cybersecurity initiatives and infrastructure resilience programs.
- Led deployment of campus-wide wireless modernization projects.
- Directed implementation of enterprise backup and disaster recovery environments.
- Oversaw modernization of enterprise authentication and identity management systems.
- Supported enterprise cloud modernization and digital service delivery initiatives.

EDUCATION

Master of Science (MSc) Artificial Intelligence, University of York (Graduated: 2025)

Bachelor of Science (BSc) Computer Science, University of Southampton

CERTIFICATIONS

ITIL Foundation | CompTIA Network+ | Linux+ | HP ATA Connected Devices

TECHNOLOGIES AND PLATFORMS

Microsoft 365, Azure and Cloud Services, Fortinet Security Solutions, CrowdStrike, Darktrace, Veeam Backup and Replication, VMware Virtualization, Active Directory, SharePoint, Microsoft Teams, Power Automate, Enterprise Networking, VoIP Systems, Cybersecurity Operations, AI and Automation Platforms, Learning Management Systems, Enterprise Infrastructure Platforms.

PROFESSIONAL STRENGTHS

Executive Leadership, Strategic Planning, AI Transformation, Cybersecurity Governance, Digital Innovation, Operational Excellence, Team Leadership, Institutional Modernization, Technology Governance, Stakeholder Communication, Enterprise Service Delivery, Cross-Functional Collaboration.

References available upon request.